

# Make the **DASH**

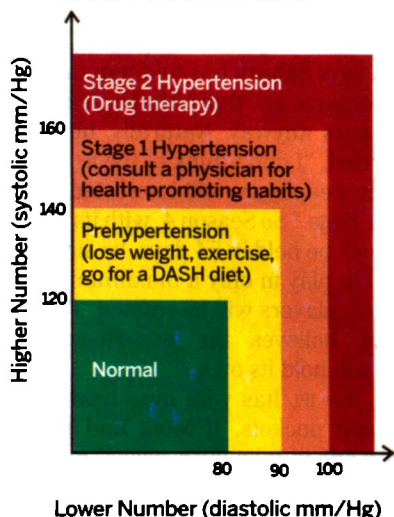
Follow the diet that helps you fight blood pressure and makes for the perfect recipe for a healthy heart

More than two-fifth of urban Indians have hypertension. Here's how the blood pressure disorder shows up...



- 16% of Indians with hypertension get ischaemic heart disease
- 24% suffer from acute myocardial infarction
- 21% get peripheral vascular diseases
- 29% of hypertensive people face a stroke
- 18% end up with cataract due to high BP

Is your blood pressure **UNDER CONTROL?**



## A DIET TO FIGHT HYPERTENSION



DASH (Dietary Approaches to Stop Hypertension) is the latest in the long litany of diet fads that crop up every now and then. Apparently it's so effective that it's being recommended by the US Dietetic Association and the American Heart Association. The trick lies in restricting salt. The diet appears to have antioxidant effects and is believed to help lower the bad LDL cholesterol. It's rich in important nutrients, fibre and foods that contain a lot more electrolytes, potassium, calcium and magnesium than are found in average diets. With it all, the DASH diet has become an overall healthier way of eating.

## DASH diet plan

Rich in greens and low on salt, it's heart-healthy diet



Sweets, limited intake



Legumes, nuts, seeds, oils for healthy fats



Low-fat dairy, fish, eggs, lean meat at level three



Breads and cereals, preferably whole grains, share level two



Veggies and fruits make the foundation. Consume as much as possible

Vegetables and fruits form the basis of this diet, followed by whole grains at level two. Low-fat dairy, fish and poultry share level three, with fish and poultry taking priority. The fourth level includes legumes, nuts, seeds and oils for healthy fats. Sweets remain at the top (not more than three servings a week).

■ Compiled by **Damayanti Datta**